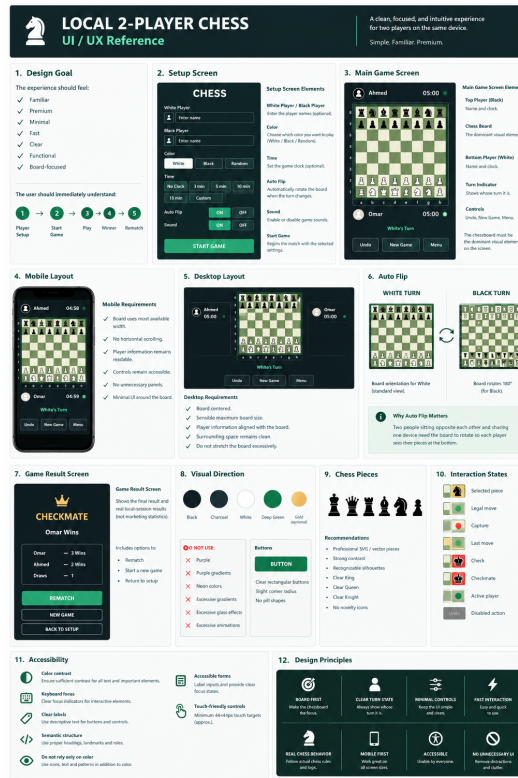


LOCAL 2-PLAYER CHESS

UI / UX Reference



Purpose. Original visual and interaction reference for a responsive browser-based chess game where two players share one device. It defines layout, hierarchy, interaction patterns, and visual direction; it is not a copy of Chess.com, Lichess, or another existing interface.

1. Design Goal

The experience should feel **familiar, premium, minimal, fast, clear, functional, and board-focused**. The user should immediately understand the progression:

Player Setup → Start Game → Play → Winner → Rematch.

- Keep the chessboard as the primary visual anchor.
- Make turn ownership obvious without requiring explanation.
- Keep controls few, predictable, and easy to reach.
- Use familiar chess interaction patterns while maintaining an original visual identity.

2. Setup Screen

Wireframe:

CHESS
White Player [Enter name]
Black Player [Enter name]

- Optional secondary controls may occupy restrained surrounding space, but never compete with the board.

6. Auto Flip

WHITE TURN → board orientation for White.

BLACK TURN → board rotates 180° → board orientation for Black.

- Auto Flip is important because two players may sit opposite each other and share one device.
- The active player should see their pieces oriented naturally toward themselves.
- Rotation should preserve game state and should not change whose turn it is.

7. Game Result Screen

Wireframe:

CHECKMATE
Omar Wins
Omar — 3 Wins Ahmed — 2 Wins Draws — 1
[REMATCH]
[NEW GAME]
[BACK TO SETUP]

The displayed win/draw counts represent **real local-session results**, not marketing statistics. They should update only from completed local games in the current session unless a separate persistence requirement is explicitly defined.

- Rematch: start another game using the relevant player setup.
- New Game: start a fresh game flow.
- Back to Setup: return to configuration.

8. Visual Direction

- **Preferred palette:** black, charcoal, white, deep green, with optional subtle gold.
- **Avoid:** purple, purple gradients, neon colors, excessive gradients, excessive glass effects, and excessive animations.
- **Buttons:** clear rectangular controls, slight corner radius, no pill-shaped buttons.
- Use contrast and spacing rather than decorative effects to establish hierarchy.
- Motion should communicate state changes, not decorate every interaction.

9. Chess Pieces

- Use professional SVG/vector chess pieces.
- Maintain strong contrast against both light and dark board squares.
- Use recognizable silhouettes with an especially clear King, Queen, and Knight.
- Avoid novelty icons, emoji-like pieces, or overly stylized silhouettes that reduce recognition.
- Keep the piece set visually consistent across the entire game.

10. Interaction States

State	Visual / interaction treatment
Selected piece	Clear square highlight and unmistakable selection state.
Legal move	Subtle destination indicator; do not obscure the board.
Capture	Distinct capture target treatment while preserving piece visibility.
Last move	Highlight origin and destination of the most recent move.
Check	Clear king/check indication using more than color alone.
Checkmate	Strong terminal-state treatment with obvious game conclusion.
Active player	Visible turn indicator paired with player name/clock.
Disabled action	Reduced emphasis plus disabled semantics; never rely only on opacity.

11. Accessibility

- **Color contrast:** Maintain sufficient contrast for text, controls, pieces, and important states.
- **Keyboard focus:** Provide a clear focus indicator for interactive elements.
- **Clear labels:** Use descriptive labels for buttons, settings, clocks, and player information.
- **Semantic structure:** Use meaningful headings, landmarks, labels, and control semantics.
- **Do not rely only on color:** Pair color with icons, text, patterns, borders, or shape changes.
- **Accessible forms:** Associate labels with inputs and provide clear focus/error behavior.
- **Touch-friendly controls:** Use sufficiently large touch targets and adequate spacing; approximately 44×44 CSS pixels is a useful minimum target.

12. Design Principles

BOARD FIRST	CLEAR TURN STATE	MINIMAL CONTROLS	FAST INTERACTION
REAL CHESS BEHAVIOR	MOBILE FIRST	ACCESSIBLE	NO UNNECESSARY UI

These principles are the final decision filter for UI additions: if an element does not support the board, turn state, interaction speed, accessibility, or core chess behavior, it should generally not be added.